

HEART TALK

You are making a sequel to Satyajit Ray's *Aranyer Dinraatri*. How did you come up with the idea?

It struck me while making a documentary on Ray. I had to see all his works. The way the maestro dealt with the tapestry of human relationships in *Aranyer Dinraatri* is very interesting. The characters provide an in-depth understanding of the human psyche and to be able to work on it is any director's delight.

You don't seem to like the term 'sequel'...

Abar Aranye is a take-off on Sunil Gangopadhyay's novel and Ray's film. It's my tribute to these stalwarts. The backdrop is not the same

here, though the characters continue to hold their charm.

Time is a crucial factor in the film, isn't it?

Well, time here is a metaphor of impermanence. It has to do with another journey, another forest, a whole new

Gautam Ghose,
Filmmaker
**ON HIS SEQUEL TO
A RAY FILM**



generation. The story leaps forward by 30 years. The characters, now elderly, venture once again into a forest, this time with their children. It's a trip down memory lane.

Rabi Ghosh as Shekhar was brilliant in *Aranyer Dinraatri*. How will you fill the void?

I know. We miss him. Shekhar will keep coming back as a memory that has become a part of the lives of my characters. He was so essential to the storyline.

Ten years down the line if someone attempts an extension of your film how will you feel about it? (Laughs) He or she is most welcome. The story will live on.....

— Neelanjana Gautam